Application for AI Engineer

Dear Ms Guerra,

Through Sonja De Greef, I came into contact with you and the Cronos Group. I recently graduated with a master's in Artificial Intelligence from KU Leuven, and I would like to apply for a position as AI Engineer within the group or one of its companies. I belong to one of the first cohorts of this programme, and therefore bring both recent academic knowledge and practical experience with real data and applications.

What struck me when I looked into the Cronos Group is how broadly AI is already being used, each time by specialised companies that know their sector well. Arinti forecasts demand for Unilever, Common Sense AI helps a pharmaceutical company review contracts faster, and Vectr.consulting used camera footage to map dangerous traffic situations for the Flemish government. From retail to pharma and the public sector, the starting point is always a concrete client problem. With the recently launched AI Lab, new ideas are also quickly tested against real business questions. That is the environment I see myself working in: close to the client, with challenges that differ from one project to the next.

At first sight, my master's thesis seems far removed from a business context, but the challenges are the same. I predicted the outcome of epilepsy surgery from brain recordings collected at two hospitals. To do so, I had to bring together data from different centres and make it comparable. Because only one outcome is known per patient, I used self-supervised learning to still learn from large amounts of unlabelled data. And to make the results usable, I built a desktop tool around it that lets a user upload recordings, run predictions and view the results in 3D. Data from different sources, few labelled examples, sensitive information and end users who are not data scientists: these are exactly the challenges that are also central to business projects.

In addition, I worked on my own projects in vision-language models and computer vision. For example, I fine-tuned a vision-language model that controls a simulated robot arm from camera images and written instructions, reaching 91% success on a standard benchmark, and I built tools that process video footage automatically.

Outside of technical work, I am a scuba diving instructor and have trained and certified more than 50 divers. This taught me to explain technical matters clearly and to take responsibility. As a freelance web developer, I also worked directly for clients.

I live in Leuven, speak Dutch and English, and am happy to work on site with clients. I would be glad to tell you more about my experience in a personal conversation. Thank you in advance for your time.

Kind regards,

Tristan Engelborghs